

DEEP RESEARCH / DUBBO NSW 2830

\$100 PC Challenge

How powerful a complete usable computer can we actually buy for AUD \$100 all-in?

TODAY'S PRACTICAL ANSWER

\$99

4th-gen Core i5/i7 office desktop

8GB RAM is realistic. An SSD is possible. A dedicated gaming GPU is not.

Research date: 23 September 2026

Hard rule: item + advertised shipping + mandatory missing parts $\leq$ AUD \$100

Prices can change quickly. Auctions are not final prices until they close.

\$100

EXECUTIVE ANSWER

What \$100 can genuinely buy today

The realistic upper end of the current public-web market is a 4th-generation Intel Core i5/i7 ex-office desktop with 8GB RAM. Two standout eBay results sat exactly on the cap with advertised free delivery: an HP ProDesk 600 G1 with i5-4590, 8GB and a 128GB SSD, and a Dell OptiPlex 9020 with i7-4770, 8GB and a 500GB HDD.

The HP is the better complete everyday machine because the SSD matters immediately. The Dell has substantially more CPU throughput, but the mechanical HDD holds back normal responsiveness. A 7th-gen OptiPlex 7050 Micro was below budget at its observed auction bid, but its final price is unknown, so it is a watch item rather than a winner.

No complete dedicated-GPU gaming PC at or below \$100 all-in was verified during this sweep. The strongest visible gaming example near the challenge was an FX-6300 + GTX 1050 + 16GB tower at \$150 firm on Gumtree - useful evidence that another \$50 changes the category completely.

CATEGORY	WINNER / FIND	OBSERVED COST
Best ready-to-use	HP ProDesk 600 G1 i5-4590 / 8GB / 128GB SSD	\$99 free delivery advertised
Best CPU	Dell OptiPlex 9020 i7-4770 / 8GB / 500GB HDD	\$99 free delivery advertised
Best auction watch	Dell OptiPlex 7050 Micro i5-7500T / 4GB / 128GB SSD	\$73.61 observed not final
Cheapest useful box	HP T630 GX-420G1 / 8GB / 32GB SSD	\$68 \$58 + \$10 delivery

Important shipping note: eBay advertised free delivery on the \$99 winners, but this research did not complete a transaction to postcode 2830. Re-open the listing and verify checkout immediately before purchase.

The best listings found

BEST READY-TO-USE

HP ProDesk 600 G1 SFF

\$99

Free delivery advertised

CPU	Core i5-4590, 4C/4T
RAM	8GB DDR3
Storage	128GB SSD
GPU	Intel HD 4600

Best no-fuss answer: the SSD makes it a complete usable desktop without spending another dollar.
3 available when checked; SFF and weak iGPU limit gaming/upgrades.

[Open source listing / search](#)

BEST CPU

Dell OptiPlex 9020 SFF

\$99

Free delivery advertised

CPU	Core i7-4770, 4C/8T
RAM	8GB DDR3
Storage	500GB HDD
GPU	Intel HD 4600

Strongest raw CPU at the hard cap. Better compute platform, but the HDD is a real quality-of-life compromise.

[Open source listing / search](#)

CHEAPEST USEFUL BOX

HP T630 Thin Client

\$68

\$58 + \$10 advertised delivery

CPU	AMD GX-420GI
RAM	8GB
Storage	32GB SSD
OS	None

Good tiny Linux/basic-compute or service box. It is not a gaming candidate.

More than 10 available; 66 sold when checked.

[Open source listing / search](#)

AUCTION WATCH

Dell OptiPlex 7050 Micro

\$73.61*

\$53.36 bid + \$20.25 postage

CPU	Core i5-7500T
RAM	4GB DDR4
Storage	128GB SSD
GPU	Intel HD 630

Newer platform and better integrated graphics, but the final auction price is unknown.

*Observed running total only. The item bid must finish <= \$79.75 if postage stays \$20.25.

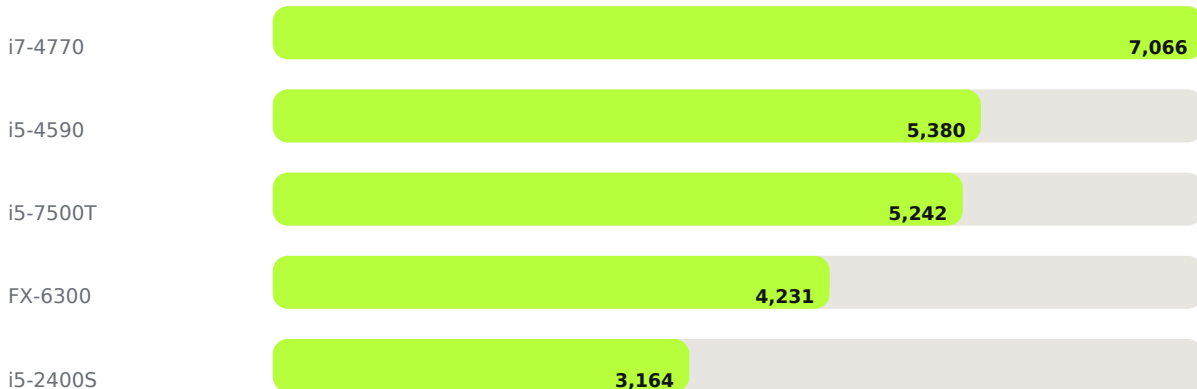
[Open source listing / search](#)

PERFORMANCE REALITY

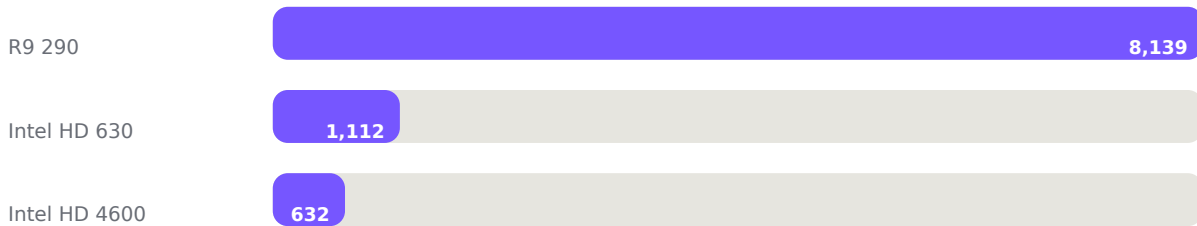
\$100 buys CPU, RAM and storage - not a gaming GPU

PassMark scores below are current synthetic reference points, not direct game FPS. They are useful for showing the scale of the gap.

CPU Mark



3D Graphics Mark



Compared with Josh's existing machines: the i5-4590 scores about 70% above the i5-2400S in CPU Mark, and the i7-4770 about 123% above it. The existing R9 290, however, scores about 12.9x HD 4600 and 7.3x HD 630 in G3D Mark. That is why none of these \$100 office PCs replaces the existing R9 290 gaming tower.

Expected tier

The \$99 HP/Dell machines are best described as strong basic/older general-purpose desktops: web, office, school/work tasks, retro emulation, older PC games, Minecraft/Roblox-class use and light esports at reduced settings/resolution. They should not be bought for current AAA 1080p gaming.

What the other sources changed - and what they did not

SOURCE	RESULT
eBay Australia	Clear winner for this snapshot: \$99 fixed-price office PCs plus sub-\$100 auction watches.
Gumtree	Cheap systems exist, but no public-indexed Dubbo $\leq$ \$100 winner was verified. A \$150 FX-6300/GTX1050 tower marks the visible entry-gaming boundary.
Facebook Marketplace	Important blind spot. Public web access does not expose a reliable exhaustive local inventory feed; no result was treated as independently verified.
Cash Converters	Low-price examples surfaced, but weak specification, distant pickup or unverified freight kept them from winning.
OzBargain	Historical evidence shows ex-office minis can occasionally reach $\sim$ \$100 delivered, but those deals expire quickly.
Mainstream PC retailers	No complete current PC near the hard cap; $\sim$ \$100 results are typically cases, accessories or services.
Dubbo local web	Local computer shops exist, but searchable used inventory under \$100 was not surfaced. Offline stock/word-of-mouth may beat the indexed web.

Why a parts build loses at \$100

A useful used GPU can consume half the budget. Barebones need RAM/storage/power. Separate postage destroys combinations. SFF systems introduce low-profile and PSU constraints. At this cap, one complete ex-office system is economically stronger than assembling several posted parts.

Visible gaming boundary

A current Gumtree tower with FX-6300, GTX 1050 2GB, 16GB RAM, 120GB SSD + 400GB HDD was \$150 firm, pickup only in Bonnyrigg. That does not qualify, but it shows why the \$100 challenge currently lands in integrated-graphics territory.

[Gumtree FX-6300 / GTX 1050 listing](#)

FINAL VERDICT

How powerful can \$100 genuinely be?

Realistic upper-end specification

**4th-gen Core i5/i7 + 8GB DDR3 + 128GB SSD or
500GB HDD + Intel HD 4600 + complete ex-office
SFF chassis**

That is a surprisingly capable older general-purpose computer, not a gaming rig. The most rational buy right now is the \$99 HP ProDesk if you want a complete machine that feels responsive immediately. The \$99 i7 OptiPlex is the better CPU if you plan to add an SSD later. If you can wait, disciplined auction watching can sometimes land a newer 6th/7th-gen micro PC below the cap.

The path to a much more exciting \$100 gaming result is not retail components. It is a badly listed local complete PC, business clearance, garage cleanout or Marketplace seller who undervalues an old dedicated-GPU tower. That is exactly what the future live version of this project should monitor.

Source links

[HP ProDesk 600 G1 listing](#)

[HP T630 listing](#)

[Dell i7 OptiPlex live search](#)

[Dell 7050 Micro live search](#)

[Gumtree \\$50 student PC](#)

[Gumtree FX-6300 + GTX 1050](#)

[Gumtree i5-4670K tower](#)

[PassMark i5-4590](#)

[PassMark i7-4770](#)

[PassMark HD 4600](#)

[PassMark HD 630](#)

[PassMark R9 290](#)

Snapshot warning: used-listing prices, stock, bids and delivery eligibility can change at any time. Re-open listings before buying. Auction bid values in this report are observations, not guaranteed purchase prices.